PRIVATE DEFI & CAPITAL MARKETS · CANTON FOUNDATION

blackrocq

A confidential OTC trading desk on Canton.

Move size without moving the market.

[redacted] [redacted] [redacted] // what the market is allowed to see

THE PROBLEM

The moment your order is visible, the price runs away from you.

A pension fund wants to buy a **$100M block of bonds**. On a lit venue, the instant that intent is visible, the market front-runs it and the price moves against the fund.

This is **information leakage** — the multi-billion-dollar reason trillions trade off-exchange, over the counter, in the dark.

ORDER INTENT LEAKS → PRICE DRIFTS

T+0 intent seen	100.00
T+1 front-run	100.42
T+2 front-run	101.09
fill price	101.63
slippage	+1.63% ≈ $1.6M

TODAY, YOU PICK YOUR POISON

Three options. Each breaks something.

PUBLIC CHAINS

Everyone sees everything.

Positions, counterparties, and size are broadcast to the entire world — and stay there forever. For an institution, that is a non-starter.

PRIVATE DATABASES

No trustless settlement.

You can hide the data, but you can't settle a trade across two firms without a trusted intermediary holding both the cash and the asset.

LEGACY OTC

Slow, manual, risky.

Bilateral messages and manual reconciliation, carrying settlement risk: one side pays while the other fails to deliver.

Nobody is private **and** atomic **and** auditable. That gap is the opportunity.

THE SOLUTION · BLACKROCQ

Private. Atomic. Auditable. All three, on Canton.

01 — PRIVATE

Invisible by construction

The request, the quote, the counterparties, and the size are visible only to the two parties involved. The rest of the market sees nothing — enforced by the ledger, not by app-level permissions.

02 — ATOMIC

Delivery vs payment

The asset and the cash change hands in a single transaction, or neither leg moves. No settlement risk, and no intermediary ever holds both sides of the trade.

03 — AUDITABLE

A regulator window

An optional regulator observes every contract. Private to the market, transparent to the regulator — the property institutions actually require.

THE WORKFLOW

From quiet request to atomic settlement.

STEP 01

RFQ

The buyer privately asks one named dealer for a price on a block.

WHO CAN SEE IT
Buyer · that one dealer

STEP 02

QUOTE

The dealer responds with a price, visible only to the two of them.

WHO CAN SEE IT
Buyer · dealer

STEP 03

ACCEPT

The buyer turns the quote into a bilateral trade both have signed.

WHO CAN SEE IT
Both counterparties

STEP 04

SETTLE · DvP

Asset and cash swap in one atomic transaction, or neither moves.

WHO CAN SEE IT
Counterparties · regulator

Privacy is enforced by Canton's **signatory / observer** model — not by application-level access control.

THE 10-SECOND PROOF

One trade. Three points of view.

COUNTERPARTIES PensionFund ⇄ BankDealer	1,000 ACME-2030-BOND	@ 950.00	950,000 USD	✓ SETTLED
RIVAL DEALER competing market maker	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	*No record. A $950K trade just settled — they see nothing.*
REGULATOR read-only oversight	1,000 ACME-2030-BOND	@ 950.00	950,000 USD	✓ AUDIT

This isn't a slide claim. Our `Setup.demo` script **asserts on-ledger** that the rival dealer can query neither the RFQ nor the Trade, while the regulator can audit the settled trade.

WHY THIS CAN ONLY WORK ON CANTON

Two capabilities. Both load-bearing.

CAPABILITY 01

Sub-transaction privacy

Through the signatory / observer model, a rival never even learns that a trade happened. Confidentiality is a property of the ledger, not a feature we layered on top.

```
// rival.query(RFQ) → ∅
```

CAPABILITY 02

Atomic multi-party settlement

True delivery-versus-payment across two institutions: both legs commit together or not at all. Zero settlement risk, and no middleman holding both sides.

```
// Settle: asset⇄cash in one tx, or neither
```

Take either away and the product collapses. **That is the test of a real Canton app.**

WHY IT WINS

Built against every judging line.

TECHNICAL

Clean, documented Daml. Privacy enforced by the ledger; atomic DvP proven with on-ledger assertions, not hand-waving.

ORIGINALITY

A regulator-observable confidential desk. Most teams build private or auditable — not both at once.

UX & DESIGN

The split-screen who-sees-what view makes invisible privacy legible to a non-technical user in seconds.

REAL-WORLD

Information leakage in block trading is a genuine, expensive, institutional problem. This is how desks actually work.

PRIVATE DEFI & CAPITAL MARKETS | OTC & PRIVATE DEAL EXECUTION | RWA & TOKENIZED DEPOSITS — THE CASH LEG

THE ASK

blackrocq

The front door to institutional capital markets on Canton.

Move size without moving the market. Private to the market, transparent to the regulator.

github.com/TheSupermanish/blackrocq